

Application for the Master in International Business

Thank you for the brief, insightful exchange with Ms. Kongthon at the QS Master's Fair in Düsseldorf, which strengthened my interest in WHU's Master in International Business.

Throughout my academic and professional journey, I have deliberately focused on combining analytical thinking with practical execution. While my undergraduate studies in Digital Marketing & E-Commerce provided a strong foundation in data-driven decision-making, my practical experiences increasingly led me to broader, cross-functional business challenges. I am particularly motivated by situations where complex problems require clear structuring and effective communication to enable well-founded decisions. The Master in International Business at WHU represents the ideal next step to further develop this profile in an international and general management context.

In the long term, I aim to pursue a career in consulting. I am particularly motivated by situations where complex problems require clear structuring, effective communication, and the integration of diverse perspectives to enable well-founded decisions. During my internships at Covestro and Deutsche Telekom, I contributed to strategic initiatives ranging from stakeholder mapping and communication architecture to market and user analyses supporting key business decisions. A particularly formative experience was my responsibility for the operational management of an international conference with over 130 speakers. In this role, I coordinated diverse stakeholders and ensured reliable execution under time pressure. This experience reinforced my motivation to work in environments that combine analytical rigor with strong execution.

Beyond my professional experience, I have actively sought responsibility in different contexts. As an elected student representative, I contributed to academic governance processes, while my involvement in basketball—as a player, certified referee, and assistant coach—has strengthened my ability to make decisions under pressure and lead teams effectively. I consider my key strengths to be structured thinking, strong analytical capabilities, and clear communication. At the same time, I continuously work to further strengthen my quantitative skill set in order to approach complex problems with greater precision. In parallel, I actively manage my professional development through the Pumpkin Careers UB Track, where I follow a structured preparation path for consulting careers. I am confident that WHU provides the ideal environment to further develop these capabilities and continue growing within a highly driven and collaborative peer group.

WHU stands out to me due to its combination of academic excellence, strong industry connections, and a highly engaged student community. The program's integration of strategy, finance, and leadership, combined with its international orientation, offers the ideal environment to develop a well-rounded global business perspective. In particular, I am motivated to contribute to forumWHU in the area of Speaker Relations, where I can build on my experience in coordinating large-scale events and working with diverse stakeholders. In addition, I plan to engage in the WHU Consulting Club to further develop my problem-solving skills in a practical setting. The close interaction with industry partners and alumni is especially valuable to me, as it will allow me to further align my academic development with my long-term career goals.

I am committed to contributing actively to the WHU community by taking on responsibility and focusing on initiatives where I can create meaningful impact. I would highly appreciate the opportunity to further discuss my application in a personal interview.

Yours sincerely,

Sebastian Arend